would find the fine, expansive grounds of Pretoria Boys' High School, our neighbours and rivals, generally known as 'Boys' High', with alumni such as Springbok rugby captain John Smit and cricketer Eddie Barlow.

As far as we were concerned, Boys' High was OK but the fates had granted Affies the prime location in Pretoria, on the main road, in the lap of Loftus, front and centre, impossible to miss.

Arriving at the main gate, you see Huis Pannevis, the red-brick boarding house for new boys, away to your left, and Huis Frank le Roux, the boarding house for Standard 7 (Grade 9) and Standard 8 (Grade 10), much further to the right. The grounds are compact but intimate, a home away from home.

The buildings are impressive but Affies is distinguished, above all, by its spirit ... something we used to call 'Affie guts', that special fighting spirit that runs through the entire school community, fuelling the energy of the boys at work and at play, driving the whole-hearted commitment of the teachers and staff. In my experience, in my time, it was the people who made the school.

It was people such as Jacques Rudolph, whom I so admired. He was three years ahead of me and, when I was 14, I remember feeling so privileged to carry his cricket bag for him. Jacques went on to play 48 Tests for South Africa between 2003 and 2012, and it was a thrill for me to be his teammate.

It was people such as Fourie du Preez, two years ahead of me at school, who shone in our 1st XV rugby team and advanced to play 164 matches for the Bulls and 74 Tests for the Springboks. In October 2015, when the Proteas were on tour in India, the players gathered in a hotel room to watch the Boks play Wales in a Rugby World Cup quarterfinal at Twickenham, and nobody cheered louder than me when Fourie scored the winning try.

It was people such as Francois Swart, Fourie's close friend and half-back partner at school, whom everybody expected would play for South